WEEK NOTES · WEEK 6

AI NATIVE

Ship it — capstone sprint & Demo Day.

Five weeks of skills. One Demo Day. You prove everything by **shipping a real product** and presenting it live. The title of AI Generalist is earned, not given.

THE IDENTITY SHIFT

AI Product Builder → AI Generalist → **Fully Native**

How to read these notes

Two sessions — the build sprint and Demo Day — each broken into short topics. Read before you build; skim the polish pass and the demo arc again the night before you present.

THIS WEEK'S SHIFT

From building things to proving them — live, in front of people.

Weekly objective

Ship a real, working AI-powered product and present it live on Demo Day — a 2-minute deck and a 3-minute live demo, Claude visible and central.

CLAUDE FEATURES APPLIED THIS WEEK

The full Claude stack — every feature, every mode, converging on one product.

Claude Code — the primary build-and-debug tool through the sprint.

API + MCPs — the product's intelligence and live tool access.

Routines + Schedules — autonomous product behaviour you can trigger live.

Projects + Connectors — full capstone context; live user data per person.

THE TWO SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Capstone build sprint — final build, the polish pass, and demo preparation.

SESSION 2

Demo Day — present, demo live with Claude powering it, Q&A & certification.

SESSION 1 – THE SPRINT

A focused build that turns last week's scaffold into a working product.

The build sprint

90 focused minutes with the full Claude stack and mentors on hand. The goal is not to start fresh — it is to turn **last week's scaffold into a working product**. Build in small loops; don't rewrite what already works.

Using CLAUDE.md live

During the sprint, CLAUDE.md keeps Claude on track: when it drifts, point it back at the file and your scope. **Update the file as the product grows**, so its context never goes stale mid-build.

Commit often

Save every working state to GitHub. A commit is a checkpoint you can return to when the next change breaks something — it turns a risky sprint into a safe one. **Working beats clever.**

SESSION 1 – THE POLISH PASS

The five things that break a live demo. Fix each before Demo Day.

Error handling

Never show a blank screen. Every failure path shows a clear message and a way to retry. Users forgive a missing feature; they do not forgive a **dead end**.

Loading states

When Claude is thinking, show a spinner and disable the button. A product that looks frozen reads as broken even when it is working fine underneath.

Edge cases

Test the empty input, the single item, and the very long input. Demos break on the one case you didn't try — so **try them first, on purpose**.

MCP reliability

A live tool call can fail. Retry once, then fall back gracefully — save locally, show a warning — instead of crashing. Reliability is what separates a demo from a product.

Mobile responsiveness

Most demos are watched on a phone. Check your layout on a narrow screen before Demo Day; a broken mobile view undoes a good build.

SESSION 1 – DECK & REHEARSAL

Turn a working product into a five-minute proof.

The demo script

Claude helps you write it: **problem** → **solution** → **live demo** → **impact**. Scripting the demo is how you fit the whole story into five minutes without rambling or freezing.

The Gamma deck

Five slides: **Problem · Solution · Demo · Stack · Impact**. One idea per slide; the deck runs two minutes, the live demo is the star. Build it last, once the product is real.

Coaching & peer feedback

90-second demos to a partner, immediate feedback, one last iteration. The fastest way to find what's unclear is to show it to someone before the room does.

Demo Day logistics

Know the format, the order, the timing and the Q&A structure before you walk up. Confidence on stage is mostly preparation off it.

SESSION 2 – DEMO DAY

The format, and the one rule: make Claude visible.

The 5-minute format

Two minutes of Gamma deck, three minutes of live product demo. **Timed.** The clock is part of the discipline — it forces you to show the best, not everything.

Show Claude live

Make the AI visible: an MCP tool call, a Routine firing, API reasoning on screen. Claude isn't hidden plumbing — **it is the point of the product**, so put it on stage and narrate it.

Live Q&A

Peers and mentors ask technical questions, challenge the use case, and ask what you'd build next. Answer honestly — "here's what I'd do next" is a strong answer, not a weak one.

SESSION 2 – THE PROOF

What you walk away with — and what it earns you.

Menler Showcase

The top builds are shared with the wider Menler community and alumni network — your work, seen beyond the cohort.

Portfolio documentation

A capstone write-up, a project README, and a demo video recording. This is the **proof you carry** into a CV, a portfolio and interviews — write it while it's fresh.

Certification criteria

You're assessed on project quality, technical depth, presentation, and peer evaluation. The title of AI Generalist is **demonstrated, not given**.

What comes next

The alumni network, continuing-education paths, and how to keep building after the fellowship. Demo Day is a start line, not a finish line.

THE MODELS TO REMEMBER

1 · THE DEMO ARC

Problem → **Solution** → **Demo** → **Stack** → **Impact**

Five beats, in order. It is your deck, your demo and your pitch — the same arc every time. Problem earns attention, Solution gives relief, Demo proves it, Stack shows the craft, Impact lands the payoff.

2 · THE POLISH CHECKLIST

Errors → **Loading** → **Edge cases** → **MCP reliability** → **Mobile**

The five things that break a live demo. Walk the list out loud before you present — four of the five Demo-Day failures live here.

3 · THE 5-MINUTE DEMO

2-min deck → **+** → **3-min live**

Two minutes of story, three minutes of the real thing running — with Claude visible. Rehearse it once, time it, and keep a recorded clip as a fallback.

YOUR TOOLKIT THIS WEEK

BUILD

Claude (full stack) — Code to build and debug; API + MCPs as the product brain; Routines for autonomous features.

Your Week 5 stack — the frontend, backend and deploy you scoped last week.

PRESENT

Gamma — the 5-slide deck from a Claude brief.

The demo script — 2-min deck + 3-min live, rehearsed once.

PROVE

Portfolio write-up — the capstone story, in your words.

README + demo video — the proof you carry forward.

Certification — quality, depth, presentation, peer evaluation.

This is the proof

Nothing feeds forward — you carry this with you. It is your portfolio, your proof, and the moment the title is earned.

KEY TERMS

The week's vocabulary, in one line each.

Capstone — the real, working product you build and present on Demo Day — your proof.

Build sprint — a focused 90-minute build with the full Claude stack and mentors on hand.

The polish pass — fixing the five things that break a live demo: errors, loading, edge cases, MCP reliability, mobile.

The demo arc — Problem → Solution → Demo → Stack → Impact — the order of your deck and pitch.

Gamma — an AI deck tool; here, a 5-slide Problem·Solution·Demo·Stack·Impact deck.

Happy path — the main flow that works end to end — rehearse it so the live demo doesn't crash.

Fallback clip — a recorded run of the happy path, shown if the live demo fails.

Demo Day — the 5-minute live presentation where you prove the product with Claude running.

AI Generalist — the certified identity you earn by shipping and demoing the capstone.